

Cindy Hsin-Liu Kao, PhD student at MIT and creator of DuoSkin, says that the tattoos are not only trendy, but cheap enough "to change and edit your appearance whenever you want." She adds that in Taiwan there is a huge culture of intermingled cosmetics and street fashion. DuoSkin team wanted to achieve the same thing by keeping the technology affordable, attractive and on trend.



Smart tattoos that allow users to control devices such as mobile phones or laptops just by touching their skin. (Image courtesy: www.studyinternational.com)

DuoSkin temporary tattoos can be made at home and washed off in a day. These use electrodes present in inexpensive gold leaves to create a conductive surface. The gold leaf and a thin layer of silicone adhere to the body to create an interface on the skin that when touched can convey certain commands to your electronic devices.

Researchers have developed three different types of tattoos. The first acts as a touchpad to control a computer cursor or adjust a music player. The second uses thermochromic pigments that change colour when body temperature rises. And, the third uses near field communication technology to transmit data such as photos between your phone and the tattoo.

Transparent gaming controller that acts like a second skin

Scientists at Seoul National University, South Korea, have created a stretchy, skin-like controller, which promises to turn a forearm into a touchpad for gaming, playing music and scrawling notes that appear on a computer screen. The team, led by researcher Chong-Chan Kim, along with Jeong-Yun Sun, a professor of materials science and engineering, imagines a future where we ditch brittle electrodes for soft, biocompatible technology.

The team developed the panel using a hydrogel made from polyacrylamide, which is a water-soluble acrylic resin, and lithium chloride salts that act like a conductor. Electrodes on both ends of the panel create a uniform

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